

Facebook gaming

About 90 percent of facebook fans come online to play Zynga Game Network's "FarmVille" & other games on Daily basis according to an survey

3D entertainment

Toshiba launched their first 3D-entertainment with the A665-3DV satellites

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The freedom of being able to use the internet anywhere is great and everyone

needs to experience that. People are being convinced to use it at work, while travelling home, going out of town, everywhere. At home for example, most of us are used to working on our desktops at one usual spot. Even laptop users end up sitting right next to where the

modem sits. Imagine being able to sit in the balcony of your home while video chatting with your relatives, or maybe browsing the net, or watching a streaming cricket match. It's not all just fun either. Wireless is great for offices. There's no need for the clutter of cables and wiring running all over the place.

Just like with any other kind of product category, routers too have a performance component to it. Wi-Fi routers have a standard for different speeds. The most popular ones has been 802.11g which offer speeds of up to 54Mbps. The test back in 2009 had many 802.11g routers but this year, we are seeing that 802.11n more popular. The 802.11n standards supports upto 600Mbps speeds which way faster than the speeds offered by most wired connections.

802.11n opens up a wide range of possibilities as well. For one, with this amount of bandwidth, it's easier to stream HD movies over the network. There's even better range offered. That being said, it's not as simple as just walking to a shop and buying an 802.11n router. A router like

any other product doesn't perform like the box and package says it will, which is why we're doing a test to tell you exactly how they perform in different conditions. Obviously, every home and office is different, but we've tried to simulate the scenarios in our own workplace.

We had to segregate the products into different categories. Most people buying routers don't look for specific features, they just have budgets. We decided to split up all the products into different price brackets.

Under Rs. 3,000

Most of us will never care for the 100 security features and the various data storage features. What matters the most is the performance at home while we browse away. For such needs, even a basic budget of under Rs. 3,000 should suffice and surprisingly, there are plenty of offerings from all the known brands.

Features

SMC is a brand that isn't known as much as Linksys, Netgear or D-Link when it comes to home routers. Their SMCWBRI4S-N4 model might be confusing nomenclature but it's a 802.11n Ethernet router. It has a pretty compact design with a smooth white finish to it. The LED display is dark blue, the firmware easy to use, but more help and information would have been preferred. Device setup, however, is quick, and although a very basic product, the use of WPS with a dedicated button will be well received by many.

The DIR-600 was one of the cheaper D-Link routers in this test. With a price of Rs. 1,900, you get a 802.11g class router for those looking for the cheapest of solutions. The build quality of the product is average. For example,



**There's
something
in the air**

Wireless networking is now faster with 802.11n routers. We test some of the latest Wi-Fi routers to see which ones fare the best